

CS 490 Software Engineering
Prof. Ellis
Constructing a Working Agreement
(Credit to Amy Ko's Cooperative Software Development course)

Goal: To create the team foundation for a Working Agreement for your team.

Step 1 - Preparation: Arrive at this meeting having read **Project Assignment 1 – Team Organization**.

(<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1UsLjlvRXj6irOspdmVNZTCAk6GR3LPKiicp3VwBga5w>)

Step 2 – Team Experience (10 minutes): Each team member should share a positive team experience, an experience in which they worked in a successful team. What were the characteristics of the team? What positive attributes come to mind when you consider that team? **Make sure that every team member shares.** List these attributes below:

Step 3 – Health Signals (8 minutes): Now identify the characteristics that you will use to identify that your team is operating well. What are some of the things that you should see? These ideas should be specific. For instance, “good collaboration” is not quantifiable. What does “good collaboration” look like? Does this mean that subteams will meet regularly? That each artifact developed by the team will be reviewed by at least one other team member? Pair-programming? What else? List these characteristics below:

Step 4 – Psychological Safety (8 minutes): Identify how the team is going to create an environment that is psychologically safe for everyone on the team.

“Psychological safety is the belief that you won’t be punished or humiliated for speaking up with ideas, questions, concerns, or mistakes. At work, it’s a shared expectation held by members of a team that teammates will not embarrass, reject, or punish them for sharing ideas, taking risks, or soliciting feedback.”

(<https://www.ccl.org/articles/leading-effectively-articles/what-is-psychological-safety-at-work/>)

How will you ensure that everyone in your team feels able to freely speak up? Describe below:

Step 5 – Accountability (10 minutes): Describe how the team will hold each other accountable. Each team member should share how they would like to be held accountable and spoken to when mistakes happen. Describe how each team member should be approached if they have let another team member down:

Step 6 – Complete the Working Agreement – rest of the time

Based on the information that you have gained during this exercise, create a Working Agreement as described in the assignment P1 – Team Organization.